

Figure 6: Subhash Browser & Feed Reader, an app created by this writer, supports user scripts and styles. JS and CSS files prefixed with an underscore will be executed/applied automatically on all pages

go through all posts in a Facebook profile's Activity Log and delete one post after another - it is much more fun that way rather than asking Facebook to delete it all in one go. This was necessitated because an older Greasemonkey script referred by an equally old article [I Decided to Delete All My Facebook Activity, by Jennifer Golbeck] had become obsolete. In another case, a Greasemonkey script I wrote to download YouTube videos as MP4/FLV/ WebM files stopped working within a month of release. Although I fixed it, it may not be long before the script needs attention again.

While it seems that user scripts and styles have a finite shelf life, the beauty of open source ensures that anyone can revive a JS or CSS and bring it back to the community.

Apart from the above-mentioned sites, greasyfork.org also provides user scripts. For a long time, Greasemonkey developers had the userscripts.org site to distribute user scripts. Before becoming defunct, the site was troubled by DMCA requests from control-freak webmasters who did not quite understand user scripts, buckled under spam/DDOS attacks and went without a full-time admin. Many

of the original developers from userscripts.org have not yet moved to the new sites. Hence, many user scripts are littered all over the Web, including sites such as gist.github.com. I would suggest that readers first trawl the comments section or the forums before installing any script or style. The Greasemonkey and Stylish extensions can be easily installed by doing a search in the Firefox add-on manager. **END**

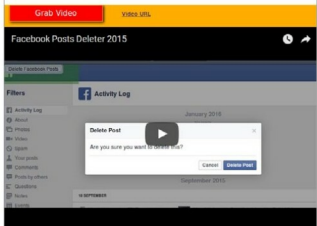


Figure 7: This screenshot shows two of my user JS in action. One has displayed a button to download a YouTube video. The video, in turn, shows a user JS in Opera 12.x browser deleting my Facebook posts!

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References

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